

and innovation, and we are continuously working in that direction.

►►►

SZ: In your assessment, when will the pressure of depending on coal reduce significantly?

Tell me, which country in the world is completely independent of such dependence?

We are continuously expanding our capacities. In fact, you should appreciate that India is a nation of 1.4 billion people.

First, one must understand our consumption pattern. Whenever we participate in global discussions, people often tell us that India ranks fourth in pollution. We respond that they should look at per capita consumption.

If you combine the most developed countries, which account for around 17% of the world's population, their consumption patterns are nearly 20 times ours. Our per capita consumption is perhaps even lower than Ethiopia's.

We are improving our lifestyle and standard of living. India's position has been that we want to be part of the solution to global environmental challenges, not part of the problem.

If you examine our efforts at three levels, the first is the Nationally Determined Contributions

that India has committed to the world. Whether it is reducing carbon emissions, increasing renewable energy capacity, or expanding green spaces and carbon sinks, we have consistently achieved our targets.

Second, we are strengthening India's capabilities through new start-ups, promoting green growth, establishing carbon credit mechanisms, and developing green credit mechanisms. We continue to make steady progress in all these areas.

Third, we believe that alongside the government's mitigation measures, adaptation practices must also become part of society. We are working on a comprehensive adaptation plan, while also encouraging behavioural change among individuals through programmes such as Mission LiFE. This includes seven areas: saving energy, saving water, saving food, solid waste management, banning single-use plastic, promoting a healthy lifestyle, and various campaigns.

In addition, the government is also working on a National Cooling Action Plan to address the challenges posed by rising temperatures, and a dedicated strategy has already been formulated for this purpose.

